

Which Language Should I Learn Next?

JAVA
C++
Lisp C .NET
Erlang
F# JavaScript C#



For novice programmers, it is difficult to decide on which programming language to learn first, or which one to try out next? The choice is vast and the complexities many. The author analyses various programming languages, and suggests making a choice based on the programmers' interests and current software trends.

As developers and engineers, our day-to-day work involves writing code and we use a particular language to express our solutions (whether it is adding features or fixing defects). When new languages come up, or there is a new release of a major language, we are eager to know more about them.

A lot is happening in the world of programming languages and I avidly watch the changes in it. As a language aficionado, I have tried spotting major trends that are emerging in the programming languages space. Naturally, my views are biased in favour of languages like C, which is one of my favourites.

Without much ado, here are the major trends I have found

in the languages landscape:

- JavaScript is becoming the *de facto* platform for the Web.
- Java and .NET are becoming two major target platforms for a large number of languages.
- Dynamic languages are on the rise.
- Functional languages are becoming popular.
- Open source languages are on the rise.
- Old languages are reborn in new forms.
- C continues to be a dominant language.

Let us discuss these trends in greater detail. And the question, "Which language should I learn next?" will be answered towards the end of the article.